Lesson notes · for you

Ask, count, tally

Data engineering · Level 1 · Lesson 1

Time	Materials
15 min	Paper and a pencil; A phone or tablet with Darsi, for the lab

Learning goals

- Say what data is.
- Collect answers with tally marks.
- Count carefully, in fives.

Activity: Our class question

1. Ask (3 min): Agree on one question, such as “Which snack do you like best?”, and three or four answers to choose from.
2. Tally (5 min): Each pupil says their answer. Two pupils draw tally marks on the board, in groups of five.
3. Count (4 min): Count each answer in fives, and check that the total is the number of pupils.
4. Share (3 min): Say which answer won, and by how many.

Choose a question with no private answers, such as snacks, fruit or colours.

Discussion

- Why are tally marks quicker than writing every answer?
- How did we check our count?
- Why does a computer think Musa and Moussa are two pupils?

Check yourself

- Draw twelve with tally marks.

Try it this week

Ask ten people at home or at school one question, such as “What’s your favourite fruit?”. Keep a tally, then count. Which answer won?

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A list says “Musa”, “Moussa” and “Musah”. How many pupils can a computer see?**

◯ One ◯ Three ◯ Two

2 **Data is facts we collect to answer a question.**

◯ True ◯ False

3 **Complete the sentence about tally marks.**

Tally marks go in groups of _____. The _____ line goes across the other four.

Word bank: five · ten · first · fifth

4 **Put the steps of a class survey in order.**

☐ Say which answer won

☐ Count in fives

☐ Collect the answers with tally marks

☐ Ask one question

5 **Match each tally to its number.**

Four lines	• • • •	10
One group of five	• • • •	8
One group of five and three lines	• • • •	5
Two groups of five	• • • •	4

What question would you like to ask your class? Why?